- To test the efficacy of a drug, a randomized control trial is conducted using a particular drug and a placebo.

Let us see the detailed methods of collecting Primary data in the following Section

2.2 Methods of collecting primary data

In this section, we present different methods of collecting primary data. In this context, we define an Investigator or Interviewer as one who conducts the statistical enquiry and the person from whom the information is collected is called a Respondent.

The primary data comes in the following three formats.

(i) Survey data: The investigator or his agency meets the respondents and gets the required data.

(ii) Experimental data (field/laboratory): The investigator conducts an experiment, controlling the independent variables and obtains the corresponding values of the dependent variable.

(iii) Observational data: In the case of a psychological study or in a medical situation, the investigator simply observes and records the information about respondent. In other words the investigator behaves like a spectator.

The various methods used to collect primary data are:

(i) Direct Method

(ii) Indirect Method

(iii) Questionnaire Method

(iv) Local Correspondents Method

(v) Enumeration Method

2.2.1 Direct Method:

There are four methods under the direct method

(a) Personal Contact Method

As the name says, the investigator himself goes to the field, meets the respondents and gets the required information. In this method, the investigator personally interviews the respondent either directly or through phone or through any electronic media. This method is suitable when the scope of investigation is small and greater accuracy is needed.

Ch2_11th Stats.indd 19 2/3/2019 10:57:31 AM